

VISUAL CONTENT SYSTEM

Kay-Twelve Image Generation & Brand Standards

A system for creating on-brand photography and social content —
from a single brief to a full platform-ready image set.

What we're building

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Kay-Twelve needs a repeatable system for creating on-brand imagery across LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, the newsletter, and the blog. Today, getting the right photo for the right platform is inconsistent and time-consuming. This system changes that.

The goal

A single brief — "show two students collaborating in a modern library space for LinkedIn and Instagram" — should automatically produce all the images needed for all requested platforms, formatted correctly, branded consistently, and ready to post.

What this system covers

- A defined visual style with clear good/bad examples
- Three named image types (shot archetypes)
- Platform-specific image formats handled automatically
- AI image generation with consistent brand defaults
- Branded social card composition
- A workflow for adding students to real environment photos

What it replaces

- One-off image requests with inconsistent output
- Manual resizing for each platform
- Judgment calls about what "on-brand" looks like
- Separate tools for separate tasks

The style guide is the foundation.

Everything the system does — every image it creates — is governed by the rules defined in that document.

Platforms in scope

Social media

LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook

Launch platforms — expandable over time

Content channels

HubSpot newsletter, blog, website

Same images, same workflow

The Kay-Twelve visual standard

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Every image Kay-Twelve publishes should answer one question: *what is learning like here?* Not "what furniture is this?" — but what does it feel like to be a student in this space.

Photography philosophy

Human-first

Students are always the emotional center. Spaces tell stories through people — never through furniture catalogs.

Natural light only

No flash, ever. Light should feel warm, even, and real — not studio-staged or artificial.

Clean but lived-in

Spaces feel usable and real. Slight imperfections add authenticity. Never sterile, never a showroom.

What we want — and what we don't

KEEP

- Wide shots that show sightlines and full space
- Students engaged in authentic activity
- Natural light from windows visible or implied
- Clean frames — furniture visible without clutter
- Action and collaboration captured in the moment
- High resolution, professional output
- Color and material choices that read clearly

AVOID

- Clutter — storage overflow, paper piles, random objects
- Students posed or smiling at the camera
- Flash photography or harsh artificial light
- Spaces with no student presence
- Grainy or low-resolution output
- Catalog-style product shots of furniture
- Distracting background elements (tape on floor, fans, trash cans)

Visual identity in images

Brand colors are used in social card design (the overlay layer), not in photography direction. Photography should feel natural and environment-driven, not color-matched to brand guidelines.



Pelorous Blue — Primary



Yellow — Secondary



Chelsea Cucumber — Secondary



Pink — Secondary



Shady Lady Gray — Secondary

The three shot types

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Every image Kay-Twelve creates belongs to one of three named categories. The category determines the camera approach, composition rules, and which platforms it's best suited for.

The Space

Wide establishing shot. Shows the full learning environment — architecture, furniture layout, sightlines, natural light. Students are optional but add warmth when present.

Best for: [Project reveals](#) [Website hero](#) [LinkedIn articles](#)
[Newsletter headers](#)

KEY RULES

- Shoot from corner or doorway
- Show full sightlines
- No foreground clutter
- Light source visible or implied

The Moment

Close action shot. One student engaged with the space — reading, writing, thinking, or interacting with furniture in a creative way. Authentic, never posed. Background softly blurred.

Best for: [Instagram feed](#) [Storytelling posts](#) [Blog in-article](#)

KEY RULES

- Student centered, head room above
- Engaged expression — not posed
- Never smiling at camera
- Space visible in background

The Collaboration

Group shot showing 2–4 students working together — discussion, problem-solving, hands-on activity. The space is equally important as the students. Energy and purpose, not posed arrangement.

Best for: [LinkedIn feed](#) [Facebook](#) [Newsletter features](#)
[Blog headers](#)

KEY RULES

- 2–4 students max
- Students face each other, not camera
- Activity visible in hands or on surface

- Furniture and layout clearly visible

One brief, every platform

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When a new image is requested, the system generates three files by default — one per aspect ratio. These three files cover every platform Kay-Twelve uses, with no manual resizing.

1:1

Square
1080 × 1080

+

4:5

Portrait
1080 × 1350

+

16:9

Landscape
1200 × 630

=

All platforms covered.

LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, newsletter, and blog — from three files. Stories and Reels (9:16) are generated on request when needed.

Platform	Use case	Format	Included in standard run
LinkedIn	Feed post	1:1	✓ Yes
LinkedIn	Article cover	16:9	✓ Yes
Instagram	Feed (primary)	4:5	✓ Yes
Instagram	Feed (square)	1:1	✓ Yes
Instagram	Stories / Reels	9:16	On request
Facebook	Feed post	1:1 or 4:5	✓ Yes
HubSpot newsletter	Header image	16:9	✓ Yes
Blog	Featured image	16:9	✓ Yes

Composition is designed for multi-format output. Every image is composed with the subject centered and generous space on all sides — so the same photo crops cleanly from a wide landscape format to a tall portrait format without losing the key subject.

How it works

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The workflow runs from a plain-language brief to a complete set of platform-ready images and branded social cards. Two one-time setup steps happen first, then the loop runs automatically every time.

One-time setup

Visual style guide

The document we're building now. Defines shot types, camera standards, platform mapping, and all generation rules. The system reads this every time it creates an image.

Social card templates

Three Figma templates (one per format) defining where the photo sits, where the logo goes, and how brand color and text are applied. Designed once, reused every time.

The repeatable loop

1

Write a brief

Describe the image and name the platforms: "Show two middle school students working together at a flexible table in a bright library space, for LinkedIn and Instagram."

2

System reads the style guide

Identifies the shot type (The Collaboration), selects the right camera settings, determines which formats are needed (1:1, 4:5, 16:9).

3

Images generated

Three image generation requests are submitted — same subject and scene, three different formats. All governed by Kay-Twelve style standards.

4

Branded social cards composed

Each photo is placed into the matching Figma card template. Logo, color bar, and optional caption text are applied automatically. Three finished cards, ready to post.

5

Deliverables ready

Raw photos (for newsletter, blog, flexible use) and branded social cards (for LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook) — organized by platform and named consistently.

Real environment photos (inpainting)

When Kay-Twelve has a professional photo of a real client space but needs students in the scene, the system can compose students into the existing environment — preserving the authentic space while adding human presence. The workflow is identical; the system routes to the right method automatically.

This document is the planning overview. The visual style guide and generation workflow are the next deliverables. Once those are complete, the system is operational.

Immediate next steps

1. Visual style guide

The complete AI-executable document and human-readable PDF. Defines all photography standards, shot types, and generation rules. **In progress.**

2. Figma card templates

Three social card master templates (1:1, 4:5, 16:9) with defined zones for photo, logo, color bar, and caption. **Follow-on.**

3. Workflow automation

The automated card composition layer that reads Figma templates and applies branding to generated photos. **Follow-on.**

Future expansion

- Instagram Stories and Reels (9:16) templates
- Video content workflow (short-form social video)
- Additional social platforms as Kay-Twelve's presence grows
- Alt-text and caption generation alongside image creation

The system is designed to grow. New platforms, new content types, and new templates can be added without rebuilding the foundation. The style guide and visual standards stay consistent regardless of how the distribution channels evolve.

